

Official Rulebook: Imperial Chess

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1. Quick Start

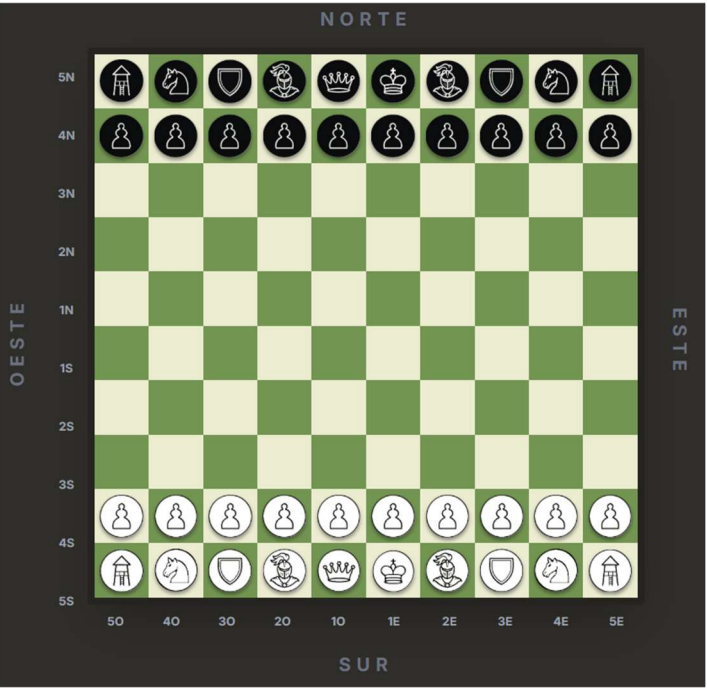
1.1 Back Row Distribution From WEST to EAST

Lookout | Knight | Squire | Paladin | Queen | Emperor | Paladin | Squire | Knight | Lookout

(The second row contains all 10 Pawns aligned).

1.2 Initial Setup and Deployment (Southern Side)

Pieces are physically identified with the initials **W** (West) or **E** (East) engraved on their design to maintain their identity regardless of how they move during the game.



Back Row (From West to East):

- **5S0:** Western Lookout (Includes W)
- **5S40:** Western Knight
- **5S30:** Western Squire (Includes W)
- **5S20:** Western Paladin
- **5S10:** Imperial Queen
- **5S1E:** Emperor
- **5S2E:** Eastern Paladin
- **5S3E:** Eastern Squire (Includes E)
- **5S4E:** Eastern Knight
- **5SE:** Eastern Lookout (Includes E)

(Image showing the location of the pieces).

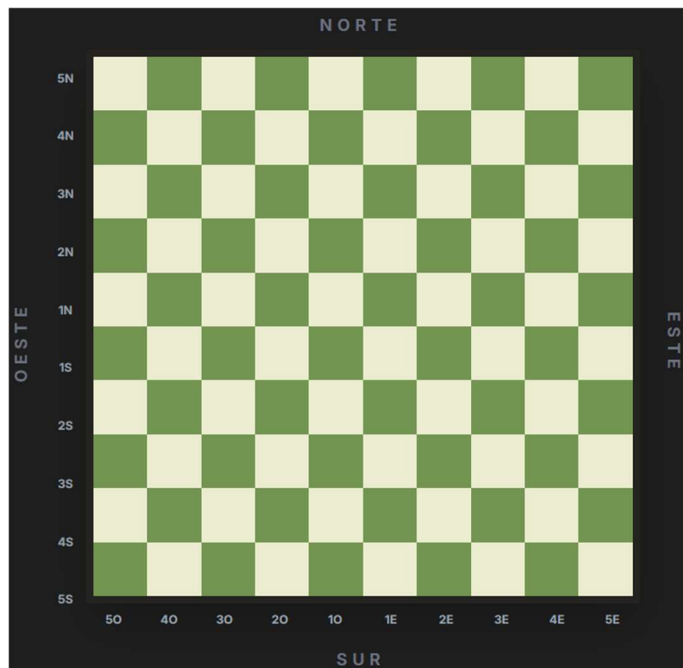
2. Special Game Rules

- **Permanent Casualties:** Captured pieces are permanently removed from the game. There is no re-entry to the board.
- **Victory Condition:** Achieved by Checkmating the enemy Emperor.
- **Tactical Note (Objective Management):** Enemy Pawns are the only means for your Lookouts and Squires to evolve into Rooks and Bishops. Capturing rival infantry with any other piece reduces your own capacity to promote your long-range artillery.

3. The Board (10 × 10)

3.1 Board Layout

The game takes place on a 10×10 board, where the center is the intersection of four central squares. A system is used that divides the map perfectly into cardinal points:



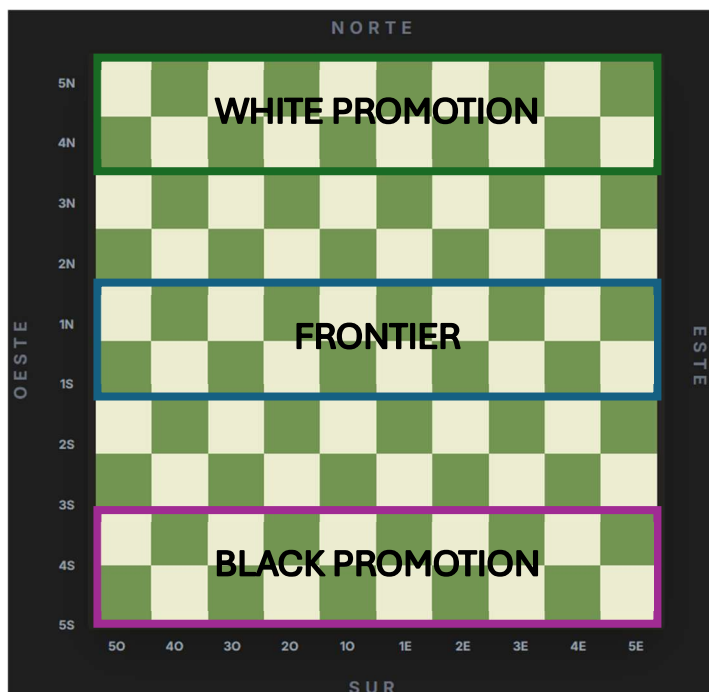
- **NORTH:** Black pieces' territory
- **SOUTH:** White pieces' territory
- **EAST:** Emperor's side
- **WEST:** Queen's side

Additionally, the board features a coordinate system that allows specific squares to be identified by assigning numbers to rows and columns.

3.2 Board Zones

It is important to identify specific zones on the board, which must be taken into account when planning a strategy.

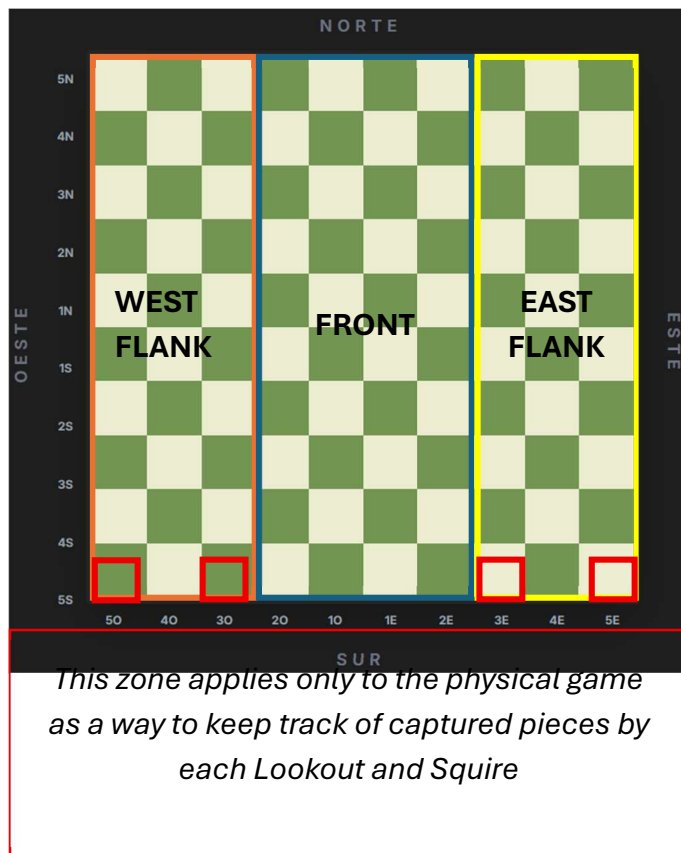
3.2.1 Zones by Rows:



- **PROMOTION ZONE:** Once a piece reaches the promotion zone, it is promoted in rank, which improves its range. Only Pawns, Paladins, and Knight can promote by zone.
- **FRONTERA:** This zone does not represent any change in gameplay, but it is one of the most important areas of the board as it is where combat tension is highest. Unlike traditional chess where center control can represent an advantage, since this board is larger, the center can be avoided. Therefore, the goal is to control the frontier partially or totally to gain an advantage

3.2.2 Zones by Columns

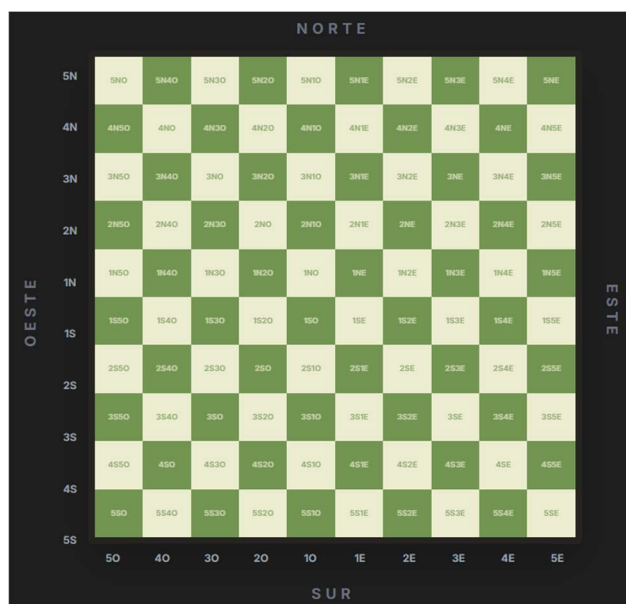
The zones differentiated by columns also have no direct effect on the pieces, but they allow for planning advance or defense strategies. Concentrating efforts on attacking or defending one of these zones establishes a playstyle, similar to openings in chess.



- **WEST FLANK:** Refers to the 3 columns from the West side, from the outside towards the center: Columns **5O, 4O, y 3O**.
- **EAST FLANK:** Refers to the 3 columns from the East side, from the outside towards the center: Columns **5E, 4E, y 3E**.
- **FRONT:** Corresponds to the central area of the board where the Emperor, the Queen, and their guards (the Paladins) are located. It spans columns **2O, 1O, 1E y 2E**
- **BARRACKS:** The space on the board right behind the starting square of each Lookout and Squire is considered their "**Barracks**". When a *Lookout* or Squire captures a pawn, it is physically placed off the board in its corresponding barracks. Upon accumulating a row of 3 Pawns in that exact barracks, the piece is crowned on the board and promoted

3.3 How to Read Coordinates

Each square is defined by its vertical and horizontal distance relative to the center (from 1 to 5), followed by the quadrant initials. Numbering advances from the center outwards.



The Central Core: The four squares touching at the center of the board are named **1NO, 1NE, 1SO, y 1SE**.

• **The Map Corners:** The bottom-left extreme corner (where the White Western Lookout starts) is square **5SO** (5 squares South, 5 squares West). The top-right extreme corner (where the Black Eastern Lookout starts) is **5NE**.

4. Units and Ranks Guide

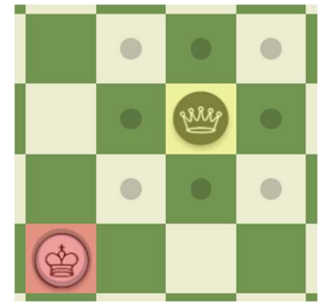
4.1 Group A: Royalty

Queen (Base): Moves 1 square in any direction.

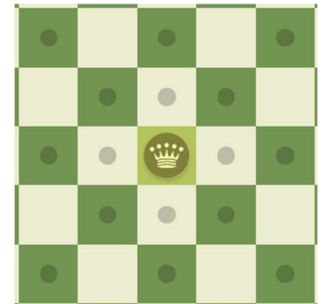


Special: If she detects an enemy piece at any distance in a straight or orthogonal line, she can move across the board exclusively to make the capture.

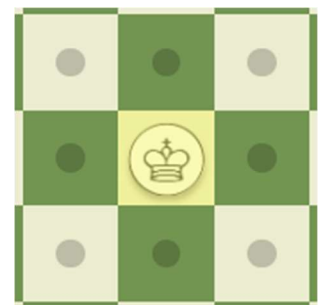
- *Promotion Condition:* Make 1 capture of any enemy piece.



Empress (Promoted): Acquires infinite movement and capture in all directions (traditional chess Queen).



Emperor: Moves 1 square in any direction. **Does not evolve.** His fall determines immediate defeat.



4.2 Group B: Siege Pieces (Evolution by Hunt)

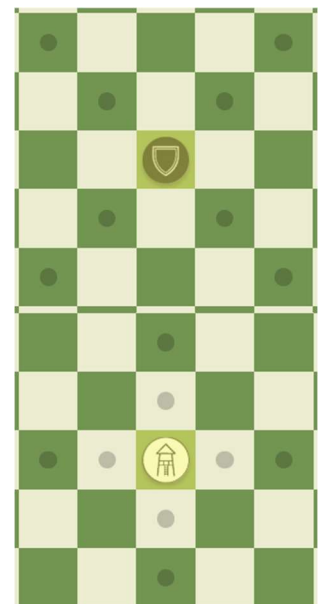
Evolve immediately after achieving their combat objective. (For the physical version, see the Barracks rule in 3.2.2)

Squire (Base): Moves diagonally up to a range of 2 squares.



- *Promotion Condition:* Capture 3 enemy Pawns.

Bishop (Promoted): Acquires infinite diagonal range.



Lookout (Base): Moves horizontally/vertically up to a range of 2 squares.



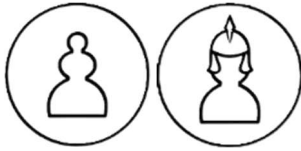
- *Promotion Condition:* Capture 3 enemy Pawns.

Rook (Promoted): Acquires infinite range in straight lines.

4.3 Group C: Shock Forces (Evolution by Territory)

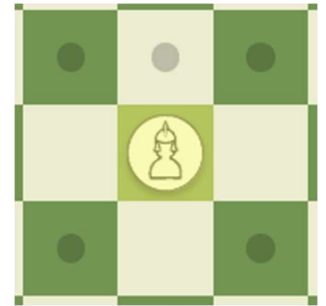
Evolve automatically upon making a move that enters, moves within, or exits the Promotion Zone (the last 2 rival rows).

Pawn (Base): Moves 1 square forward (no initial double step). Captures 1 square diagonally forward.



Promotion Condition: Enter the Promotion Zone.

Sergeant (Promoted): Moves 1 square in any frontal direction or in the two rear diagonals



Knight (Base Piece): Moves using the classic "L" shape (two squares in an orthogonal direction and one square perpendicular). It is the only piece on the board capable of jumping over other units (both allied and enemy) during its trajectory.



○ *Promotion Condition:* Enter the Promotion Zone.

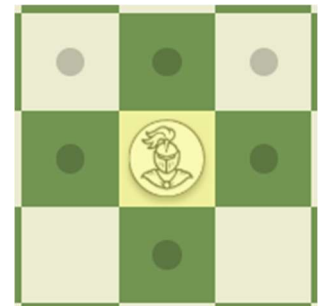


Imperial Knight (Promoted Class): Retains its "L" jumping ability intact. Additionally, it acquires the ability to move or capture 1 square away in orthogonal directions (up, down, left, right).

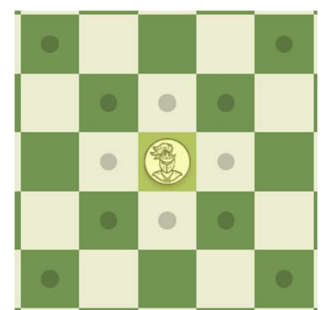


Paladin (Base): Advances exactly 1 square in almost any direction around it (frontal, lateral, rear-center, and frontal diagonals), with the exception of the two rear diagonals. This grants a total of 6 possible destination squares. Does not jump pieces.

○ *Promotion Condition:* Enter the Promotion Zone.



Imperial General (Promoted): Maintains its orthogonal movements limited to 1 square (cross), but evolves its diagonal range. It is now capable of moving up to 2 squares away in any of the 4 diagonal directions (both frontal and rear), stopping to capture or if its path is blocked by another piece.



4.4 Piece Values

In **Imperial Chess**, each piece has a score measuring its strength and utility on the board. These values do not restrict how you move your pieces, but they are the ideal guide for making good decisions: they help you calculate if an exchange is worthwhile, how strong an attack is, and who holds a material advantage in the game.

We take the Pawn as the base unit of measurement (100 points). From there, the rest of the pieces are worth more according to their range, mobility in tight spaces, and evolution capacity

<i>Piece</i>	<i>Value</i>
<i>Pawn</i>	100
<i>Squire</i>	250
<i>Caballo</i>	350
<i>Vigía</i>	400
<i>Paladin</i>	450
<i>Queen</i>	550
<i>Emperor</i>	10000

<i>Piece</i>	<i>Value</i>
<i>Sergeant</i>	280
<i>Bishop</i>	330
<i>Rook</i>	500
<i>Imperial Knight</i>	550
<i>Imperial General</i>	700
<i>Empress</i>	1000

Beginner's Tip

When evaluating a piece exchange during the game, add up the points of what you are giving away and compare them to what you will capture. If you gain more points than you lose (or if you manage to evolve one of your pieces), the exchange has been a tactical success.

5. Advanced Tactics

5.1. Imperial Castling (Castle Creation)

Imperial Castling is a special dual-unit move designed to evacuate the Emperor from the hostile center and erect an immediate defensive fortress on the flanks, merging the speed of classical castling with the compact structure of Shogi castles.

Mandatory Requirements to Activate It

1. **Terrain Clearance:** All intermediate units of the chosen flank (Paladin, Squire, and Knight) must have moved and left the corridor between the Emperor and the Lookout clear.
2. **Previous Immobility:** Neither the Emperor nor the Lookout chosen for castling must have moved from their starting squares during the entire game.
3. **Attack Immunity:** The Emperor cannot be in Check, nor can he cross or land on any square threatened by enemy pieces during the movement.

5.2 5.2 Castle Creation

5.2.1 Type A: The East Fortress Castle (Short Flank)

Because the Emperor starts on the East column (1SE), the path to the East Lookout (5SE) is shorter (only 3 intermediate squares).

- **The Movement:** The Emperor moves 3 squares to the east and settles in **4SE**. Simultaneously, the Eastern Lookout moves inward and positions itself in **3SE**.
- **Final Defensive Structure:** To consolidate the castle you propose in your tests, the formation of pieces in the SE quadrant will be distributed as follows after optimal development:

Unit	Cartographic Position	Fortress Role
Emperor	5S4E (Back row)	Protected in the corner by the Lockout's stone wall.
Eastern Lockout	5S3E (Back row)	Acts as the left buttress blocking the central columns.
Eastern Squire	4S4E (Middle row)	Positioned right in front of the Emperor, defending his direct diagonal.
Eastern Paladin	3S3E (Advanced line)	The Paladin patrols the castle crown, protecting critical squares.
Active Pawn	3S4E	Advanced on the outer wall to gain space.
Active Pawn	3S2E	Advanced to connect the defense with the center of the board.
Immobile Pawn	4S3E	Remains static as the direct infantry shield of the Lookout.

5.2.2 Tipo B: El Castillo del Bastión Oeste (Flanco Largo)

Since the Emperor starts on the East side, the distance to the Western Lookout (5SO) is longer (4 intermediate squares, crossing the Queen's starting square). This generates a tactical asymmetry identical to that of traditional chess.

- **The Movement:** The Emperor must make a long march by moving 4 squares to the west to settle in 3SO. Simultaneously, the Western Lookout flies inward crossing over the Emperor to position itself in 2SO.
- **Real Strategic Impact:** The final safety offered by this castle is exactly the same as that of the East Flank, since the Emperor ends up at the same distance from central danger. However, its preparation cost is higher because you are forced to evacuate the Imperial Queen (1SO) first before you can activate the move. It is a high-risk tactical decision: it takes more turns to protect your Emperor, but it allows you to consolidate your Queen in a decentralized offensive position.